

FACTS ABOUT THE AMERICAS

Number of birds

More than 3,400 species of bird live in South America. Colombia alone has more than 1,800 breeding species. Fewer than 1,000 species of bird are found in North America north of Mexico.



Largest lake

Lake Superior is the largest of the Great Lakes of North America and the largest freshwater lake in the world.

Longest mountains

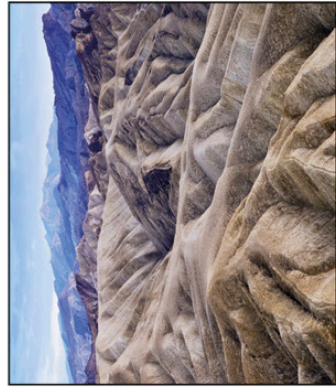
The Andes are the longest mountain chain on Earth, stretching for more than 4,500 miles (7,250 km) down the west side of South America.

Long river

The Amazon in South America is the second longest river in the world, after the Nile. One-fifth of all the fresh water on Earth flows through it each day. The river pours into the Atlantic Ocean with such force that it is possible to scoop up a glass of fresh water 200 miles (320 km) out to sea.

Highest waterfall

The Angel Falls in Venezuela are the highest in the world at 3,212 ft (979 m).



Highest temperature

Death Valley in North America is one of the hottest places on Earth. Summer temperatures are often higher than 131°F (55°C).

Oldest mountains

The Appalachians are some of the oldest mountains in the world and were formed more than 250 million years ago.

Typical birds

Here are just a few examples of typical birds from the most important habitats of the Americas. You can find out more about them on the next few pages.

Deserts

All the wrens in the world except for one species live in the Americas. This cactus wren prefers a desert habitat.



Grasslands

This burrowing owl lives on the grasslands and deserts of the Americas. Nearly 60 species of owl live in the Americas, including screech owls and pygmy owls.



Mountains

Guanos, such as this shy Andean guan, live mainly in the mountain forests of South America.



Woodlands

Crows, magpies, and jays, such as this noisy blue jay, are common in the woods of North America. More than 30 species of jay live in the Americas.



Rainforests

There are nearly 40 species of toucan, and aracari living only in South American rainforests. This toco toucan is a common species.



Rivers, lakes, and swamps

Perching ducks, such as this wood duck, nest in tree holes near water. Other typical ducks of the Americas include whistling ducks, steamer ducks, teal, eider, and scoter.

